

tients. Take the example of AMR and TB, where India faces a critical need for innovation, yet the current pipeline doesn't adequately cover these areas due to financial constraints. To address this, both the government and private insurance sectors can contribute to a solution. The establishment of a body tasked with evaluating the cost-benefit of each new drug discovered and researched in India is a start. Subsequently, insurers can collaborate to financially support patients in accessing these newly discovered drugs.

Riding the wave of preventive healthcare

There's a discernible shift in how people view health, with a growing desire to stay healthy longer. A recent Ernst & Young survey found that 40% of Indians are willing to pay more for health and wellness products, reflecting a preventive approach to well-being. Consumer healthcare is now India's fastest-growing segment, with a strong year-on-year CAGR of 10-11%. Pharmaceutical and FMCG companies are now strategically positioning themselves to tap into this expanding market.

This transformation is notably propelled by digital health technologies, like wearable devices, health tracking apps and other tools that equip individuals with the information and means to track various aspects of their health. Furthermore, the shift towards point-of-care, personalised and at-home diagnostics is reshaping healthcare delivery.

The next half-decade promises a

healthcare landscape where individuals are not just passive recipients of care during times of illness but active participants in their ongoing wellness journey.

Healthcare equity in the hinterlands

The World Health Organization's 2030 agenda emphasises the need to reduce avoidable inequity. Equity in healthcare is a non-negotiable goal,

mentals. This should be coupled with a conducive environment for research and development of new treatments, both for common and rare diseases.

Utilisation of the innovative strengths and manufacturing capacities of various players, coupled with strong government support, can ensure the widespread availability of new and advanced therapies across rural areas. This

proven approach was instrumental in achieving equitable access to vaccines and treatments during the Covid-19 pandemic. Ambitious initiatives like Ayushman Bharat Health and Wellness Centres (AB-HWCs) are also shining examples of how need-based healthcare services can be extended to all citizens. Data-driven insights can further refine these initiatives, ensuring effective and targeted

interventions—both online and offline—to communities that need them the most.

At the end of the day care is going to be deeply rooted in how India sees its role in the world. As we look ahead to 2029, the vision of prosperity, progress, and inclusivity in healthcare isn't just a national agenda; it's a global responsibility that India proudly shoulders. **BT**

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and India's demographic diversity demands a healthcare system that is not only innovative and future-ready but also accessible to all segments of the population. While technology certainly has a role in improving drug and healthcare delivery, it's imperative to recognise that not everyone has the access, or the literacy required to navigate digital healthcare platforms effectively. Therefore, investments in healthcare must prioritise the continuous strengthening of the funda-